Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH **0500/01**

Paper 1 Reading **For examination from 2027**

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 80

Converted

This mark scheme accompanies a converted question paper: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500/13 October/November 2024, restructured to the 2027–2029 Paper 1 format. The reading texts in the insert are unchanged.

Where a question has been carried over, the indicative content is transferred unchanged, because the text has not changed and the creditable points have not changed. Questions marked **generated** are new and their indicative content has been written for this conversion.

Level descriptor tables are reproduced unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme (0500/01/SP/27). Conversion decisions are recorded in the note on page 4.

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Generic Marking Principles

All examiners must apply these general marking principles when marking candidate responses. Examiners must apply them alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptions for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme must also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptions for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptions for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always whole marks (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded positively:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptions.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however, the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptions in mind.

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English & Media-Specific Marking Principles

(To be read in conjunction with the Generic Marking Principles (and requiring further guidance on how to place marks within levels))

Components using level descriptions:

- We use level descriptions as a guide to broad understanding of the qualities normally expected of, or typical of, work in a level.
- Level descriptions are a means of general guidance, and should not be interpreted as hurdle statements.
- Where indicative content notes are supplied for a question, these are not a prescription of required content, and must not be treated as such. Alternative correct points and unexpected answers in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the knowledge and skills demonstrated.
- While we may have legitimate expectations as to the ground most answers may occupy, we must at all times be prepared to meet candidates on their chosen ground, provided it is relevant ground (e.g. clearly related to and derived from a relevant passage/text and meeting the mark scheme requirements for the question).

Components using point-based marking:

Point marking is often used to reward knowledge, understanding and application of skills. We give credit where the candidate's answer shows relevant knowledge, understanding and application of skills in answering the question. We do not give credit where the answer shows confusion.

From this it follows that we:

a DO credit answers which are worded differently from the mark scheme if they clearly convey the same meaning (unless the mark scheme requires a specific term).

b DO credit alternative answers/examples which are not written in the mark scheme if they are correct.

c DO credit answers where candidates give more than one correct answer in one prompt/numbered/scaffolded space where extended writing is required rather than list-type answers. For example, questions that require n reasons (e.g. State two reasons …).

d DO NOT credit answers simply for using a 'key term' unless that is all that is required. (Check for evidence it is understood and not used incorrectly.)

e DO NOT credit answers which are obviously self-contradicting or trying to cover all possibilities.

f DO NOT give further credit for what is effectively repetition of a correct point already credited unless the language itself is being tested. This applies equally to 'mirror statements' (i.e. polluted/not polluted).

g DO NOT require spellings to be correct, unless this is part of the test. However spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. Corrasion/Corrosion).

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Notes on this converted mark scheme

Question 1 order. Sub-parts run in the order of their anchors in Text A. Generated items were interleaved by anchor, not appended, so letters stay (a)–(e). The R4 item on 'wondrous' (¶2, line 7) shares old 1(c)'s paragraph and lead, so old 1(c) becomes 1(c)(i) and the new item 1(c)(ii). The R3 item on 'ambitious' (¶3, line 11) sits between old 1(d)(i) (benefits, ¶3) and old 1(d)(ii) (problems, ¶4) as 1(d)(ii), so old 1(d)(ii) becomes 1(d)(iii). Neither generated item is on paragraph 5, which old 1(e) already covers.

Question 3 mark split. This paper follows the specimen allocation exactly: 3(a) 2 × 1, 3(b) 3 × 1, 3(c) 5, 3(d) 10, totalling 20.

The source 2(a) carried four one-mark identification items and the 2027 3(a) has room for two. All four source 2(a) items are R1 in the 2024 mark scheme, so no R1/R2 pair was available. Kept 2(a)(iii) 'amazing' (an evaluative word in direct speech) and 2(a)(iv) 'stoop' (a physical action), the two with a single, unambiguous answer. The items not carried forward are:

- 2(a)(i) way down → '(the) descent' (line 6) / '(we) descend' (line 1), R1
- 2(a)(ii) looked closely at → '(Jodie and I / we) studied (the Underground City website)' (line 20) / 'googled ('family-friendly trips' on my phone)' (line 10), R1

Question 3(d). The 2027 language task prints a single extract and names a specific focus, where the source 2(d) referenced two paragraphs. Kept: paragraph 5, 'Jodie was right …' (the heat in Tassos), printed in full; 10 indicative entries carried. Dropped: paragraph 1, 'We descend …' (the stairway down into Underground City) and its 7 indicative entries and overview.

- 2(a) and 4 use the specimen mark line ('Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to N marks for writing') in place of the 2024 wording, matching the specimen and the existing converted papers.
- 3(c) stem adapted to the specimen shape ('explain how the writer uses language to suggest …'); the 2024 stem read 'explain how the writer suggests Simon's thoughts and feelings …'. The focus is unchanged. 3(c) was 3 marks with point-banded guidance; it is now 5 marks on specimen Table D. Its old 3/2/1 award rules no longer apply; indicative content is unchanged.
- 3(a)/3(b): underlining converted to bold; 'words underlined' becomes 'words in bold'.
- 4: word count 250–350 → 250–300; marks 15 reading + 10 writing → 10 + 10. The letter form is on the 2027 list.

Table substitutions. Tables A, B, C, D, E, F and G below are taken unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme 0500/01/SP/27. No table has been reworded or rescaled.

Generated questions. 1(c(ii)), 1(d(ii)), 2(b) are new to this conversion. Each was tested for answerability against the insert alone before its indicative content was written. 2(b) targets the writer's attitude, so it cannot be answered from content already creditable in the 2(a) summary.

Insert. Insert passed through unchanged. Its 'Read Text X, and then answer Question …' cue lines still carry the 2024 question numbers (1(a)–(e), 1(f), 2(a)–(d) and 3); the conversion prompt forbids editing the insert, so candidates should be told the cue lines are superseded by the question paper.

Source discrepancies.

- The 2024 3(c) extract (old 2(c)) stops mid-sentence at 'Not my favourite thing to do ...'; the insert continues '…, but Jodie looks excited.' The extract is printed as the 2024 paper printed it.
- The 2024 mark scheme's 2(c) indicative content quotes 'open landscape under a vast sky was a tempting idea'; the insert reads 'is a tempting idea'. Carried verbatim.
- The 2024 mark scheme heads 2(b)(i) with the 2(a) stem ('Identify a word or phrase from the text …'); the question paper's 2(b) stem ('Using your own words, explain …') is used.

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Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 1

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3, R4 and R5 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

Overview of items for Question 1

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
1(a)	R5	1
1(b)(i)	R1 and R2	2
1(b)(ii)	R1	2
1(c)(i)	R1	2
1(c)(ii)	R4 *(generated)*	2
1(d)(i)	R1, R2 and R5	2
1(d)(ii)	R2 and R3 *(generated)*	3
1(d)(iii)	R1, R2 and R5	3
1(e)	R1 and R2	3
Total		**20**

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Question	Answer	Marks
1(a)	**What is the name of the type of building that is built a long distance downwards into the ground?** Award 1 mark for: • earthscraper(s) / inverted skyscrapers	1
1(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by:** **'impressive distance' (line 4)** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • substantial / significant / sizeable / considerable / amazing / great / surprising / very long • way / length / depth	2
1(b)(ii)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by:** **'countless structures' (line 5).** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • innumerable / (a) huge number of / numerous / many / lots of / uncountable • buildings / constructions	2
1(c)(i)	**Re-read paragraph 2 ('Countless structures ... architectural plans.').** **Give two reasons why an underground car park could not be described as an 'earthscraper'.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. • shallow setting / not deep (enough) / (too) shallow • not multifunctional / serves a limited purpose • unexciting • earthscrapers are fictional / no earthscrapers have been built yet	2
1(c)(ii)	**Re-read paragraph 2 ('Countless structures ... architectural plans.').** **Explain the effect of the word 'wondrous' (line 7).** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. A response that only gives a synonym (e.g. 'amazing') without explaining its effect should be awarded a maximum of 1 mark. • suggests something marvellous / magical that fills people with awe and amazement • has a fantastical / fairy-tale quality that fits the fact that earthscrapers exist 'only in fiction and architectural plans' – they are not yet real • conveys the writer's own enthusiasm / admiration and draws the reader in – reinforced by 'excite our imaginations' • raises earthscrapers above the ordinary, 'shallow' car parks and arenas mentioned earlier in the paragraph	2
1(d)(i)	**Re-read paragraphs 3 and 4 ('One proposal ... the project.').** **Give two ways in which Mexico City might benefit if an earthscraper was built.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. • resolves problems created by restricted space and growing population • provides more amenities / wider range of amenities (allow any two example(s) from: more living space / more retail space / more office space / a museum) • historic buildings (above ground) can be conserved	2

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Question	Answer	Marks
1(d)(ii)	**Re-read paragraphs 3 and 4 ('One proposal ... the project.').** **Using your own words, explain why the writer describes the Mexican proposal as 'ambitious' (line 11).** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. Answers which are entirely in the words of the text should not be credited. Benefits already creditable in 1(d)(i) gain credit here only where they are linked to the scale or scope of the proposal. • its enormous depth / scale ('65-storey deep') – far beyond the shallow structures that have been built underground so far • nothing like it has ever been built – earthscrapers exist 'only in fiction and architectural plans' – so it attempts something untried • it packs many different uses into one structure ('living, office and retail spaces as well as a 10-floor museum') • it would sit beneath the city's 'central square' – the busiest, most important / historic part of a huge city • it sets out to solve several large problems at once – shortage of space, growing population and protecting the city's 'threatened historic buildings'	3
1(d)(iii)	**Re-read paragraphs 3 and 4 ('One proposal ... the project.').** **Explain why building the Mexico City earthscraper could be seen as problematic.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 3. • its depth / engineering issues (linked to depth) • (make provision for) Mexico City having a hot climate • needs adequate ventilation / providing sufficient ventilation • need (to employ) people of great creativity and intelligence / exceptional workforce needed	3
1(e)	**Re-read paragraph 5 ('There are mixed feelings ... to consider too.').** **Using your own words, explain why some people might be against earthscrapers.** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. Answers which are entirely in the words of the text should not be credited. • not necessarily environmentally friendly / effect on environment • energy to cool and heat • expensive to construct / other financial priorities (for governments) • extra pollution / more traffic jams	3

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Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 2

Question 2(a) tests the following reading assessment objectives (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

This question also tests the following writing assessment objectives (5 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context.

Question 2(b) tests the following reading assessment objectives (5 marks):

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text.

Overview of items for Question 2

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
2(a)	R1, R2 and R5	10
	W1, W2 and W3	5
2(b)	R2 and R3 *(generated)*	5
Total		**20**

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Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)	**According to Text B, in what ways can someone buying and living in their first underground home ensure that it is a positive experience?** **You must use continuous writing (not note form) and use your own words as far as possible.** **Your summary should not be more than 120 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 5 marks for writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(a) (Table A, Reading and Table B, Writing). **INDICATIVE READING CONTENT** Candidates may refer to any of the points below: • 1 being optimistic / looking on the bright side / not giving up easily • 2 appropriate research (into locations and/or home insurance) • 3 make sure you have enough money to invest / be prepared to spend more than you would on a house above ground • 4 buying a pre-built home / do not build the house yourself • 5 join an existing underground community / do not choose an isolated area / find a support network • 6 be realistic / consider practicalities / temper your dreams / heed advice / be prepared to compromise • 7 good drainage / waterproofing • 8 effective insulation • 9 access to natural light / designed with light in mind / good architect taking account of light • 10 an area open to the sky / able to see the sky • 11 managing the wildlife that come into the house / providing habitat for visiting creatures / allow animals to visit	15

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Marking criteria for Question 2(a)

Table A, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• An effective response that demonstrates understanding of a wide range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are skilfully selected to demonstrate an overview.
4	7–8	• A mostly effective response that demonstrates a competent understanding of a good range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are carefully selected and there is some evidence of an overview.
3	5–6	• A partially effective response that demonstrates understanding of a range of relevant ideas with occasional loss of focus on text or task. • Some evidence of selection of relevant ideas but may include excess material.
2	3–4	• A basic response that demonstrates general understanding of relevant ideas and is sometimes focused on text and task. • Some indiscriminate selection of ideas.
1	1–2	• A response that demonstrates limited understanding of relevant ideas and shows limited focus on text and task. • Little evidence of selection of ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

Table B, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2 and W3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	• Expression is clear and fluent. • Organisation is effective. • Concise use of a range of appropriate vocabulary.
2	2–3	• Expression is generally clear. • Organisation is sometimes effective. • Areas of concision but some reliance on the words of the text.
1	1	• Expression lacks clarity. • Organisation is limited. • Includes lifted sections.
0	0	No creditable content.

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Question	Answer	Marks
2(b)	**Assess the writer's attitude towards living underground.** **Use three details from Text B to support your answer.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(b) (Table C, Reading). Credit is for identifying the writer's attitude and supporting it from the text, not for retrieving the practical advice already creditable in 2(a). Credit any other attitude that is valid and supported. Responses might use the following: • clear-eyed / cautionary – warns that it is demanding and not for everyone (paragraph 1): 'It wasn't a scheme for the faint-hearted'; 'a substantial amount of cash' • wistful / regretful at giving up a romantic dream, though accepting it was sensible (paragraph 2): 'This saddened us'; 'indulged in a romantic notion'; 'It would have been a dream'; 'we sadly concluded' • eager and pragmatic – happy to settle for a compromise that works (paragraph 3): 'we jumped at the opportunity'; 'a good compromise to my ideals'; 'We could cross those concerns off our list.' • delighted / enthusiastic, and keen to correct others' gloomy assumptions (paragraph 4): 'We were so excited to move in! It was lovely.'; 'How thrilling!'; 'People imagine that an underground home must be dark and gloomy'; 'our own slice of the natural world' • good-humoured and affectionate about the wildlife that shares the home (paragraph 5): 'uninvited guests'; 'This is just as well'; 'one of which actually allows me to pet him'	5

Table C, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R2 and R3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's attitude with relevant support from the text.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's attitude with some supporting detail.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's attitude.
0	0	No creditable content.

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Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 3

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers.

Overview of items for Question 3

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
3(a)(i)	R1	1
3(a)(ii)	R1	1
3(b)(i)	R1	1
3(b)(ii)	R2	1
3(b)(iii)	R2	1
3(c)	R1, R2 and R4	5
3(d)	R1, R2 and R4	10
Total		**20**

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Question	Answer	Marks
3(a)(i)	**Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words in bold:** **Underground City appears awe-inspiring on the narrator's phone.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • amazing (line 21)	1
3(a)(ii)	**Before they enter the chamber, the visitors have to lean forwards and lower their heads.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • (so we) stoop (slightly) (line 25)	1
3(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words in bold:** Milo is waiting for us to gather round him. He smiles **expansively** and **beckons** us closer. His eyes **pick out** Ben and a young girl, the only two children present. **expansively** • expansively: broadly, widely, in a friendly way, encouragingly, in a welcoming way	1
3(b)(ii)	**beckons** • beckons: gestures, waves, motions, call(s) (over), signs, signals, ushers	1
3(b)(iii)	**pick out** • pick out: select(s), choose(s), identifies, settle(s) on, decide(s) on, spotted, noticed	1

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Question	Answer	Marks
3(c)	**Use one example from the text below to explain how the writer uses language to suggest Simon's thoughts and feelings on the journey back to the hotel.** **Use your own words in your explanation.** I notice how the volcanic rock and soil that had made burrowing underground so easy once means that this is not a land of fertile forests. A handful of lonely broken trees wither in the dry flat land as far as the eye can see. An evening walk to see this open landscape under a vast sky is a tempting idea. My camera would capture some spectacular panoramic vistas. Meanwhile, Milo is telling us about a must-visit outdoor market selling local crafts. Not my favourite thing to do ... Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(c) (Table D, Reading). The explanation must be predominantly in the candidate's own words. Responses might use the following: • I notice how the volcanic rock and soil that had made burrowing underground so easy once means that this is not a land of fertile forests: interested in how the make-up of the ground is conducive to digging downwards but not to growing vegetation / has changed into land that is no longer habitable; curious; different from vegetation he is accustomed to • A handful of lonely broken trees wither in the dry flat land as far as the eye can see: the few, isolated trees are dying; visible up to the horizon; sadness; like a (movie) scene of destruction; wasteland • open landscape under a vast sky was a tempting idea: enticing thought; attracted by idea; wants to experience this huge empty space; free from restrictions • capture some spectacular panoramic vistas: take a photo; beautiful, eye-catching wide shots; amazing sweeping views; wants to record these sights forever; enjoys photography • Not my favourite thing to do: understatement; ironic; has done this sort of thing before (under sufferance); finds markets tedious, hates them; prefers natural settings	5

Table D, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's use of language.
0	0	No creditable content.

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Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	**Choose three powerful words or phrases from the extract below to analyse how the writer uses language to describe the heat in Tassos.** Jodie was right about the heat outside. The sun had been unrelenting since our arrival, but fortunately, most of Tassos is within a short distance of the coast. On our morning beach visits, fresh breezes whipped the heaviness out of the air, while fun in the sea energised us. But now, sitting in the still courtyard of our hotel, everywhere was parched and begged for hydration. In front of me a dying tree had collapsed, its trunk riven at the base. Oddly, its spindly uppermost branches still stretched skyward, while its lower boughs wept dry tears into the cracked earth. Write about 200 to 250 words. Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(d) (Table E, Reading). **Notes on the task** This question is marked for the ability to select powerful or unusual words and for an understanding of ways in which the language is effective. Expect responses to provide words / phrases that carry connotations additional to general meaning. Mark holistically for the overall quality of the response, not for the number of words chosen, bearing in mind that for the higher bands there should be a range of choices to demonstrate an understanding of how language works, and that this should include the ability to explain images. It is the quality of the analysis that attracts marks. Do not deduct marks for inaccurate statements; simply ignore them. The following notes are a guide to what good responses might say about the selections. Candidates can make any sensible comment, but only credit those that are relevant to the correct meanings of the words in the context and that have some validity. Alternative acceptable explanations should be credited. Credit comments on effects created by non-vocabulary choices such as grammar / syntax and punctuation devices. These must be additional to comments on vocabulary. Only credit comments on stylistic effect where these are explicitly linked to choices.	10

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Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	Responses might focus on words or phrases from the following: • (the sun had been) unrelenting: never stopped; constant heat; would not give up; as if doling out a punishment; deliberately torturing the humans • fresh breezes whipped the heaviness out of the air: cool gusts replaced the still heat; beat, swiftly drove the heat away; sense of relief; coming to the rescue; asserting authority; chasing away the oppressor • fun in the sea energised us: revitalised; brought back to life; set them up for the day; carefree • parched: dried out with heat; baked in the sun; scorched, thirsty • begged for hydration: desperate for water; imploring, pleading, yearning • collapsed: completely broken; fallen away • (its trunk) riven at the base: completely split in half at the bottom • spindly uppermost branches still stretched skyward: top of the tree pointing vertically; as if (reaching arms upwards and) pleading • (lower boughs) wept dry tears: falling, desiccated leaves; bent down towards the ground as if in a position of grief; helpless; hopeless; defeated • cracked earth: split ground; lacking moisture, damaged, painful	

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Marking Criteria for Question 3(d)

Table E, Reading: Analysing how writers achieve effects

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Analysis adds meaning and associations to precisely selected words/phrases and demonstrates the writer's reasons for using them. • Explains images with some precision and imagination. • Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
4	7–8	• Some analysis of carefully selected words and phrases offers secure explanations of meanings within the context of the text. • Begins to identify and explain images. • Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
3	5–6	• Chooses appropriate words and phrases. • Mostly explains meanings of words. • Attempts to suggest and explain effects are basic or general.
2	3–4	• Chooses words and phrases that communicate less effectively within the context of the text. • Explanations repeat the language of the original and/or are general, slight or only partially effective. • Correctly identifies linguistic devices.
1	1–2	• Choice of words is rarely relevant. • Comments offer limited evidence of understanding.
0	0	No creditable content.

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Question 4

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5 (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

and writing assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4 (10 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

W4 use language appropriate to audience and purpose.

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Question	Answer	Marks
4	**You are Jodie. After your holiday to Tassos, your friend asks you whether you would recommend Tassos as a holiday destination for them and their young children.** **Write a letter to your friend in which you:** • **describe the area of Tassos and give your thoughts about it** • **explain why you visited Underground City and give your thoughts about the experience** • **describe what else there is to do in Tassos and give your advice about the best ways to make sure that the holiday is enjoyed by the whole family.** **Write about 250 to 300 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 10 marks for writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 4 (Table F, Reading and Table G, Writing). **Notes on the task** Candidates should select ideas from the text (see below) and develop them relevantly, supporting what they write with details from the text. Look for an appropriate register for the genre, and a clear and balanced response which covers the three areas of the question, is well sequenced, and is in the candidate's own words. Annotate A1 for references to the area of Tassos and your thoughts about it Annotate A2 for references to why you visited Underground City and your thoughts about the experience Annotate A3 for references to what else there is to do in Tassos and your advice about the best ways to make sure that the holiday is enjoyed by the whole family	20

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Question	Answer	Marks
4	**A1: describe the area of Tassos and give your thoughts about it** • temperature / heat (det. unrelenting, cracked earth) [dev. can be intolerable] • location / area (det. near coast, fresh breezes) [dev. relieved that they are no further inland] • vegetation (det. no forests, few trees) [dev. disappointing / different to what they are used to / land is not suitable for growing plants] • landscape (det. flat land, volcanic rocks) [dev. uninspiring / unappealing / barren] • accommodation / hotel (det. courtyard to sit in, no children's activities) [dev. uninteresting / not luxurious] **A2: explain why you visited Underground City and give your thoughts about the experience** • Simon's idea (det. feeling guilty about Ben, family-friendly trip) [dev. initial scepticism / turned out to be a good idea] • website (det. eight floors over 100 metres, 13th century) [dev. huge / persuaded to visit] • access (det. dark labyrinth, narrow twists and turns, holds Ben's hand) [dev. dangerous / adventure] • (friendly) guide (det. Milo, provides refreshments, outlines history) [dev. cares about safety / knowledgeable / educational] • living areas (det. teaching areas, shops, communal spaces) [dev. disappointed that not allowed to visit all of it / relieved not going to unsafe areas / fascinating] • Ben made a friend (det. Anna, staying in a nearby hotel) [dev. pleased for Ben / he will enjoy the holiday more] **A3: describe what else there is to do in Tassos and give your advice about the best ways to make sure that the holiday is enjoyed by the whole family** • sea (det. fun, morning activity, energising) [dev. easily accessible] • market (det. outdoor, selling local crafts) [dev. enjoyed going there with Anna's mum / opportunity to sample local culture] • evening walks (det. taking photos, panoramic vistas, vast sky) [dev. safe to explore / pursuing own interests] • (limited) contact with other children (det. only two children on the trip, exchanged phone numbers with Anna's mother) [dev. plan to meet up / choose a hotel with activities for children] • transport (det. air-conditioned coach) [dev. worth the extra money / more comfortable for longer journeys] • protect against the heat (det. advised for young children) [dev. potentially dangerous to stay long in the sun]	

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Marking Criteria for Question 4

Table F, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• The response reveals a thorough evaluation and analysis of the text. • A wide range of ideas is applied. • Developed ideas are sustained and well related to the text. • There is supporting detail throughout, which is well integrated into the response, contributing to a strong sense of purpose and approach. • All three bullets are well covered. • A consistent and convincing voice is used.
4	7–8	• The response demonstrates a competent reading of the text with some evidence of basic evaluation or analysis. • A good range of ideas is evident. • Some ideas are developed but the ability to sustain them may not be consistent. • There is frequent, helpful supporting detail, contributing to a clear sense of purpose. • All three bullets are covered. • An appropriate voice is used.
3	5–6	• The response shows that the text has been read reasonably well. • A range of straightforward ideas is offered. • Opportunities for development are rarely taken. • Supporting detail is present but there may be some mechanical use of the text. • There is uneven focus on the bullets. • The voice is plain.
2	3–4	• There is some evidence of general understanding of the main ideas, but the response lacks focus on the text or the task. • Some brief, straightforward reference to the text is made. • There may be some reliance on lifting from the text. • Limited focus on the bullets. • The voice might be inappropriate.
1	1–2	• There is very limited evidence of engagement with the text. • Content is either insubstantial or unselective. • There is little realisation of the need to modify material from the text.
0	0	No creditable content.

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Table G, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Effective style. • Carefully structured for benefit of the reader. • Wide range of vocabulary, used with precision. • Effective use of language for audience and purpose.
4	7–8	• Sometimes effective style, mostly fluent and clear. • Ideas generally well sequenced. • Range of vocabulary, used with some precision. • Sometimes effective use of language for audience and purpose.
3	5–6	• Clear, plain style. • Relies on the sequence of the original text. • Range of vocabulary is adequate. • Some awareness of audience and purpose.
2	3–4	• Inconsistent style, expression sometimes awkward. • Response is not well sequenced. • Vocabulary is simple, limited in range or reliant on the original text. • Limited awareness of audience and purpose.
1	1–2	• Expression unclear. • Very brief and undeveloped. • Copies sections from the original text. • Little attempt to explain ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

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